

BEIJIA (FREYA) ZHU

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PERSONAL SUMMARY

Interaction design master's student with a psychology background, interested in how bodily, affective, and sensory forms of interaction can shape human-technology experience. My work engages with research-through-design, speculative design, tangible interaction, interaction prototyping, and quantitative behavioural research across design and psychology contexts.

EDUCATION

Master of Interaction Design and Electronic Arts, The University of Sydney Aug. 2025 – Present

- Current WAM: **83.3/100**, and it's expected to reach **85/100** after this semester.
- IDEA 9105 Interface Design: **86** • IDEA 9106 Design Thinking: **87**

Bachelor of Science, Major in Psychology, The University of Melbourne 2021 – 2023

- Completed psychology training in research methods, statistical analysis, and APA-style academic reporting.

Science, UNSW Foundation Studies 2020

- Final GPA: **9.8 / 10**

RESEARCH-RELEVANT PROJECTS

HeartLine – Speculative Tangible Interaction Design 2026

IDEA9201 Experience Design Laboratory *Individual Project*

- Developed a research-through-design project that reinterprets swipe-based digital intimacy through a tangible, heart-shaped telephone, exploring how choice, anticipation, and emotional feedback can be expressed through physical interaction.
- Used object analysis, annotated imageboards, sketching, AI-assisted visualisation, joystick interaction, and breathing light states to investigate affective feedback through form, rhythm, movement, and subtle sensory cues.

Disney Dream – Immersive Experience and Spatial Interface Proposal 2026

DESN9002 Strategic Digital Design *Individual Project*

- Developed a speculative proposal for an immersive VR-based extension of Disney Parks, exploring spatial interfaces, AI guidance, IP-based virtual worlds, and digital souvenirs as part of a continuous experience ecosystem.
- Produced user scenarios, journey flows, interface concepts, and visual communication materials to examine virtual presence, embodied navigation, personalisation, and interactive storytelling.

FloodSafe – Emergency Interaction Design 2025

IDEA9105 Designing Interactions *Team Project*

- HD, supervised by Marius and Hubert.
- Designed the iPad/tablet interface for an emergency response application addressing recurring flood risks in Australia.
- Structured interaction flows and information hierarchy to support clear risk communication, safety guidance, and decision-making in high-stress contexts.

Psychology Capstone Research – Alcohol Consumption and Sleep Quality 2023

Bachelor of Science, Major in Psychology, The University of Melbourne

- Completed a quantitative psychology research project examining the relationship between alcohol consumption patterns and sleep quality.
- Conducted literature review, statistical analysis in R, and APA-style academic reporting, applying methods including ANOVA and regression analysis.

RESEARCH METHODS AND SKILLS

- **Design Research:** Research-through-design, speculative design, literature review, user research, usability evaluation, scenario building, prototype evaluation.
- **Quantitative Research:** R Studio, t-test, ANOVA, regression analysis, survey design, empirical data interpretation.
- **Design and Prototyping:** Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Premiere Pro, interaction flow design, interface design, AI-assisted visualisation.

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Academic and professional working proficiency
- **Mandarin Chinese:** Native speaker